



HEALTHY CROWDS, SAFER FESTIVALS

Summary of key insights from the UPBEAT Study on **Safety and Public Health Measures at Belgian Music Festivals**

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1. INTRODUCTION

UPBEAT is a study on health and safety measures at Belgian music festivals. Intended for a broad audience, this document provides an accessible overview of the project's findings and discussions rather than a full scientific report.

The main objective of the UPBEAT project was **to identify needs, challenges, and potential avenues for developing a drug policy tailored to festivals in Belgium**. Conducted as a six-month “quickscan” (July–December 2024), the study provides a focused snapshot based on festivals. However, its findings also contribute to **broader discussions on drug policy in nightlife settings** more generally. Subsequent to the quickscan, several meetings with policymakers have been organized on the basis of these findings, helping to translate insights from the project into practical policy dialogue.

This study was initiated to take **a bottom-up, participatory approach to drug policy** in festival settings, reflecting years of insights, experiences, and discussions among those directly involved. These include attendees, festival organizers, health, legal, and security professionals, policymakers and scientists. UPBEAT responds to ongoing debates about the benefits of a more coordinated and integrated approach to drug-related health and safety interventions across federal, regional, and local levels of governance, and provides a foundation for future research and policy development.

This document first describes the methods used for this research along with the associated limitations. There were two main phases, each aimed at a specific sub-goal. The first phase consisted of **mapping the various types of health and security initiatives** currently implemented at music festivals in Belgium, using a primarily descriptive approach. The second phase focused on actively **engaging local operational stakeholders** to better understand the main issues surrounding these initiatives.

We then present the key findings that emerged from the discussions with operational stakeholders, highlighting the needs and challenges identified by participants.

Finally, we conclude with a summary of the **main insights from discussions held with policy makers**, both national and international, focusing on how the findings translate into insights for practical steps forward.

2. METHODS AND LIMITATIONS

There were two main phases to the study (see Figure 1 for full project roadmap).

Figure 1. UPBEAT Project Roadmap



Phase one used a mixed-methods approach to explore existing drug-related initiatives at Belgian music festivals. It combined several qualitative and quantitative data sources, including participant observation at selected festivals, an online survey targeting festival attendees, and the analysis of drug seizures, wastewater samples, and drug-related health incidents. To provide an overview of the information gathered, Table 1 in Appendix 1 shows the status of data collection and analysis for each source, while Table 2 summarizes the response rates for the online survey. This phase was not intended to produce a comprehensive or comparative data overview, but to provide a broad and contextual understanding of current practices. It served as a starting point for deeper engagement with operational stakeholders.

In **phase two**, we organized four focus group discussions as part of a needs assessment for policy development. These involved 25 stakeholders from different professional backgrounds, such as festival organizers, security personnel, police forces, judicial authorities, and health and harm reduction professionals. To structure the discussions and draw on participants' expertise, the research team developed four thematic statements based on the initial findings from phase one (see Appendix 2). These were intended to prompt reflection, encourage dialogue, and help identify opportunities, challenges and potential directions for drug-related policy and interventions in festival settings.

Several limitations affected the scope and depth of the methodology. The six-month timeline of this rapid assessment limited the ability to achieve consistent data coverage across events. For instance, collecting seized substances requires agreements with public prosecutors, which were not always secured in time. Similarly, time constraints and coordination issues meant that not all partners were able to provide data on drug-related health incidents.

Despite these limitations, carrying out both phases one and two was essential. Given the current momentum in drug policy development in Belgium, the timing of even partial evidence is important. In a context where research opportunities and funding are limited, generating timely and evidence-informed insights – even if not exhaustive, supports ongoing discussions and helps identify priority needs. Likewise, the participatory approach used in phase two ensures that these insights are grounded in local realities. Together, these elements provided meaningful insights and allowed us to engage with **the study's main objective: to identify needs, challenges, and future avenues for drug policy and initiatives at music festivals.**

3. KEY FINDINGS

The discussions based on the quickscan results summarized in Appendix 3 can be organized around four main themes: (i) Drug use at festivals – Insights and strengths for data collection, (ii) Public attitudes toward support services, (iii) Harm reduction as

a complementary support tool, and (iv) Training and collaboration between sectors, with a focus on coordination.

This summary of the needs assessment does not aim to identify majority versus minority views. Rather, it seeks to illustrate the key issues, points of tension, and real-world conditions that should be considered in the development of drug-related policies at music festivals.

3.1. Drug Use at Festivals : Insights and Strengths for Data Collection

Participants acknowledged that **the consumption of alcohol and other drugs occurs across all types of festivals**, regardless of genre or size, indicating that all festivals are concerned by this phenomenon. However, they emphasized **the lack of reliable data to better understand the associated health and safety issues**, which complicates pre-festival planning. The phenomenon remains under-researched, and the absence of timely and relevant data hinders the design of appropriate interventions.

Linked to this concept, participants identified several types of data that would support further developments and should therefore be prioritized in research agendas: **trends in consumption, market dynamics, substance composition and the impact assessment of existing initiatives and monitoring tools**. This includes evaluating the potential value of harm-reduction interventions such as drug checking. They stressed the need for this information to be collected not only during festivals but also beyond these events, on a larger societal scale and with regular updates. Opinions nevertheless varied on the practical implementation of these tools and on how results should be disseminated (see also section iii).

According to participants, having access to useful data would help tailor services more effectively to the needs of organizing parties, festival attendees and the drug-related challenges they face. They also reflected on their own role in collecting and interpreting such data, emphasizing the value of combining different approaches. For example, while the analysis of drugs seized by the police was seen as informative, some noted it might not fully reflect actual consumption. Substances identified through harm reduction services were viewed as a useful complement, offering different insights into patterns of use. These discussions pointed to **a shared interest in improving coordination between various data collection methods** to gain a clearer picture.

Finally, participants expressed the need for agreement on key indicators and **improved information sharing across sectors**. While some organizations already actively share data, others do not always receive information in return, which complicates their work. In addition, some participants were not familiar with certain data sources such as wastewater analysis, highlighting a broader need for clearer communication about existing research.

3.2. Public attitudes towards support services

Representatives from all sectors reported having **limited tools to assess how the public perceives their services** or to evaluate their own impact, both during festivals but also beyond these settings. They expressed a strong interest in better understanding festivalgoers' attitudes to seeking help and support when incidents occur.

Among services not specialized in drug issues, the topic is often difficult to address with the public. This was attributed to a **lack of training, limited knowledge, persistent taboos, and a lack of trust**. Some participants observed that festivalgoers sometimes prefer to report drug-related incidents or sexual harassment on social media rather than approach professionals or on-site services. This tendency can fuel public criticism and deepen the divide between festivalgoers and support services.

The discussions highlighted **the role of harm reduction services** that lower thresholds by working with peers or volunteers who are close to the target audience and can act as intermediaries. They also emphasized that informal, peer-to-peer communication remains crucial, as it complements official event communication channels and helps build trust with festivalgoers. Nonetheless, certain groups, especially women and young people, remain particularly hard to reach. Participants also raised the **lack of visibility** of these services which may contribute to unequal access across different festivals.

Furthermore, participants stressed the importance of a **comprehensive prevention strategy, with efforts to build trust extending beyond the festival setting – in time and in place**. They underlined that prevention is not an on-the-spot deliverable but requires continuous, year-round investment in order to be effective when implemented during events. A holistic approach was seen as essential for building long-term relationships with festivalgoers and improving prevention outcomes. These efforts should address a broad range of issues, not only the use of alcohol and drugs but also sexual harassment and safety among crowds.

Some participants noted that festivals can serve as a valuable entry point for first contact with people who use drugs. Strengthening this initial connection could help guide individuals toward prevention and support services after the event and in their daily lives. From this perspective, **drug-related interventions at festivals** are not only relevant for the event itself but **represent a significant public health opportunity** more broadly.

3.3. Harm reduction as a complementary support tool

Harm reduction itself remains insufficiently known and often underemphasized in comparison with other pillars of drug policy, which contributes to the mixed views

expressed by stakeholders. While it is one intervention among others, participants felt it nonetheless deserved particular attention, as it raises recurring questions and **requires clearer acknowledgement within the Belgian policy framework.**

Participants expressed mixed views on harm reduction initiatives. Representatives from harm reduction services noted that their work is often politicized, rather than treated as a public health priority. The **absence of robust impact evaluations** makes it difficult to measure the effectiveness of harm reduction interventions and to guide the discussion. Without consistent data, assessing outcomes and adapting to local contexts remains a challenge.

Participants also highlighted **unequal access to harm reduction services across festivals.** For example, the legal status of drug checking varies across regions and depends heavily on local prosecutors, making its implementation unpredictable from one year to the next. **Disparities in the overall provision of harm reduction services** are explained by a lack of long-term structural funding, the absence of clear legal frameworks, and staff shortages, which undermine both service quality and public trust. In Wallonia, efforts were described as fragmented whereas Flanders was perceived as more coordinated. This variability illustrates a broader underlying issue: **the absence of a coherent national framework, leading to heterogeneous implementation across regions.**

To address these disparities, some participants called for the establishment of a **minimum national framework for harm reduction and prevention initiatives, similar to existing requirements for security and medical services.** The “Quality Nights” label was highlighted as a promising model, offering a standardized yet adaptable framework across regions. While there was interest in harmonizing practices, such as through shared training and protocols, some participants also warned against overly rigid standardization. They stressed that flexibility remains essential to meet the unique needs of each festival and local context.

Drug checking was discussed as a specific harm reduction intervention by the participants, illustrating the broader challenges of engaging with people who use drugs. Some participants saw drug checking as a way to warn festivalgoers in real time about dangerous substances and reduce health risks, while others raised concerns that it could normalize or encourage drug use, a point also echoed by some festival organizers. Suggestions for compromise included keeping drug checking discreet, focusing communication on risks rather than substance quality, and relying on word-of-mouth rather than public dissemination.

While drug checking was part of the discussion, it mainly highlights again the earlier mentioned broader issue of **the need for platforms that facilitate dialogue and interaction with people who use drugs.** Drug checking is just one example of how such engagement can occur, and the discussions underscore that effective harm

reduction depends on creating these opportunities for communication and collaboration, rather than relying on one single intervention.

3.4. Training and Collaboration between Sectors: The Role of Coordination

The previous themes revealed the general need for coordinated action in areas such as information sharing, legal clarity, financial support, and preparedness at all levels of governance. This fourth theme focused more explicitly on **coordination as a means to support the implementation of drug-related health and safety measures**, including ensuring that staff and crew are adequately prepared to collaborate effectively across sectors.

The discussions reflected growing interest in moving beyond individual initiatives **towards a more structured national approach**. French-speaking representatives in particular called for more regular meetings across sectors, not only for specific festivals, but also on a broader level. They suggested **preparatory meetings before the festival season and debriefings afterwards** to foster continuous learning, improve coordination and align expectations between stakeholders. Some participants saw potential value in establishing **a dedicated coordination body** to improve coherence and planning across festivals and regions, though the discussions did not clarify who would be responsible or what its specific functions might be.

Beyond festivals, participants widely agreed on the importance of enhancing collaboration with public authorities. Improved **coordination between field services and governmental institutions** will help prevent fragmented responses and promote policy continuity. This should not be limited to the festival season but integrated into a consistent national drug policy throughout the year.

4. TOWARDS FUTURE POLICY ACTION

Knowledge translation is a key objective for policy supporting research. Building on this main objective of the UPBEAT project, the findings of the needs assessment from phase two were used to **formulate seven key priority actions** (Appendix 4). These were discussed during two events to explore their feasibility and to identify how to better align event risk management with national drug strategies. In this sense, this project has already contributed to policy discussions while representing only initial steps in a longer-term development process.

This section provides a concise overview of the main insights that emerged from these exchanges. Its purpose is not to detail every discussion point. We focus on highlighting several key insights relevant for future policy development and on illustrating how next steps may be undertaken, first drawing on the Belgian national policy dialogue and then on the international expert exchange (see figure 1, page 3).

4.1. From needs to policy reality in the Belgian context: Feedback meeting December 2024

In December 2024, a national policy dialogue on the UPBEAT project was organized with Belgian stakeholders involved in drug policy making. The aim was to explore the implications of the project's findings for national policy development and to clarify policy requirements for the coming years.

During these conversations, several main insights were articulated and serve as take-home messages and starting points for future policy discussions. In summary, the dialogue confirmed:

- **Strong support for a more explicit and coordinated national approach** to drug policy development and implementation in the context of events, including music festivals. This includes recognition of local initiatives and harm reduction practices, and the need to consider all pillars of drug policy: (i) rules and agreements, (ii) education, (iii) care and guidance, and (iv) environmental interventions. Participants emphasized the value of cross-domain coordination across prevention, law enforcement, harm reduction and care (linking mainly to priority actions 1 and 4).
- **The importance of information-sharing and preparedness**, requiring a more structural approach to establishing research agendas – including evaluations and methodological development – for drug-related (and other) interventions at festivals in Belgium (priority actions 2 and 3).
- **The need for operational coordination roles** to bridge the gap between policy and field practice. To enable intersectoral collaboration and alignment with an integrated policy at local and event levels, participants saw potential value in a

national framework offering structure and formalized good practice, including a dedicated coordination function (priority actions 5, 6 and 7).

Participants noted **the limited attention to supply-side risks**, calling for a more integrated understanding of both the health of people who use drugs and the criminal dynamics involved, to support a more coherent approach.

A distinction emerged between different clusters of priority actions:

- **Priority actions 1–4** concern national-level, long-term strategic development. These require a jointly supported framework – a complex challenge, yet one that cannot be postponed without constraining future possibilities.
- **Priority actions 5–7** are interlinked and more immediately feasible at regional, local, or event levels. They can motivate stakeholders to pursue parallel development pathways, including piloting initiatives and evaluating them to build the evidence base needed for higher-level policy discussions. A broader research agenda would help align these efforts and ensure synergy.

Overall, this dialogue illustrates how research, stakeholder participation, and continued engagement with policymakers contribute to effective knowledge translation.

4.2. From needs to policy reality in international context: Best practice exchange

A second example of follow-up to the needs assessment took place in May 2025 during a focus group held at the Club Health Conference in Ghent. This international expert exchange brought together stakeholders involved in policymaking, research, and local initiatives related to drugs in nightlife settings, with the aim of exploring best practices and understanding areas of alignment and divergence across countries.

The exchange underscored how widespread many of the challenges identified in Belgium are. Stakeholders from Ireland, the Netherlands, Portugal, Luxembourg, Croatia, and Belgium described similar major obstacles: fragmented responsibilities, legal grey zones, and a heavy reliance on motivated individuals or volunteer-based models. Their insights highlighted the structural limitations of bottom-up harm reduction approaches when they lack clear mandates, sustainable funding, and national support or coordination.

Participants stressed the need to move beyond informal agreements and toward structured frameworks that embed minimum harm-reduction requirements into licensing procedures, safety planning, and national strategies, among other examples discussed during the meeting.

5. CONCLUSION

Taken together, these discussions make clear that the problem is not a lack of knowledge or good practice, as Belgium and its partners already have many of the tools needed. The real gap lies in the need to develop structured, coordinated frameworks that ensure these practices are supported, legitimized, and implemented coherently.

As a result of this participatory research process, we are now moving toward a shared roadmap that connects national policy intentions with practical, local implementation across three strategic axes:

- Operational **coordination roles and mechanisms at the local or regional level** in order to ensure these responses are effectively implemented in practice;
- **Policy recognition** and national coordination in order to support legitimacy and guidance to a **harm reduction approach** in nightlife and festival contexts.
- **Investment in research, preparedness, and data-sharing** in order to support continuous learning and appropriate timely responses;

This evolving roadmap can be seen as a platform for collective action. It is shaped by what we have learned from stakeholders in the field and at both national and international levels of governance. The next phase will involve refining these elements into practical tools, partnerships, and pilot projects that continue the conversation and translate it further into sustained action.

APPENDIX 1 :

METHODOLOGY FOR PHASE 1 – MAPPING HEALTH AND SECURITY INITIATIVES AT BELGIAN MUSIC FESTIVALS

Table 1. Overview of data collection and analysis status per source

	Observation Report	Incidents	Drug seizures	Wastewater
Festival 1	Data collected & analyzed	Data unavailable	Data unavailable	Data unavailable
Festival 2	Data collected & analyzed	Data collected & analyzed	Data collected & analyzed	Data collected & analyzed
Festival 3	Data collected & analyzed	Data unavailable	Data unavailable	Data collected & analyzed
Festival 4	Data collected & analyzed	Data collected & analyzed	Data unavailable	Data unavailable
Festival 5	Data collected & analyzed	Data unavailable	Data collected & analyzed	Data collected & analyzed

Table 2. Overview of the responses to the online survey

Total responses	825
Responses kept in the analysis population	434
Full responses	307

APPENDIX 2.

FOUR STATEMENTS USED TO GUIDE THE FOCUS GROUPS

1. DRUG USE AT FESTIVALS

- Illicit drug use **occurs across all festivals**, regardless of their size, musical genre, or location.
- To better manage associated risks, it is **essential to place greater emphasis on upstream preparation**, including staff training and the dissemination of up-to-date information, with **annual updates on drug market trends** and emerging threats.
- Monitoring the presence of drugs during events **is necessary**. However, methods such as wastewater analysis are costly and insufficient for real-time risk management.
- To be effective, this type of monitoring requires **a coordinated, efficient, and consistent approach** across events.
- In addition, it should be complemented by periodic monitoring or by strengthening an early warning system capable of **tracking long-term trends**.

2. PUBLIC ATTITUDES TOWARDS SUPPORT SERVICES

- Drug use, particularly among young people, **can lead to adverse effects**.
- While first aid services are perceived as the primary source of support, drug use is rarely addressed within these settings, highlighting **a lack of trust** on the part of service users. There is therefore a need to better understand **barriers to service use** as well as **drug-related incidents**.
- Easily accessible support services are essential, not only during festivals but also **as part of a broader prevention strategy**.
- This strategy should include **upstream actions** (e.g. awareness-raising campaigns and annual training on drug-related risks) to complement initiatives implemented during events.

3. HARM REDUCTION : BEFORE, DURING AND AFTER FESTIVALS

- The absence of clear harm reduction guidelines results in **uneven implementation and limited recognition** of measures in festival settings.

- A clear and standardised harm reduction strategy is needed. This strategy should be integrated into broader prevention efforts and **embedded within a national drug policy**.
- It should address substance use **before, during and after festivals**, with a focus on public awareness and access to existing support services.
- Further research is needed **to assess the effectiveness of initiatives** and to adapt them to emerging needs and trends.
- In summary, harm reduction initiatives **must be visible, recognised**, and not rely solely on the individual efforts of festivals. This would support a more comprehensive and effective approach.

4. TRAINING AND COLLABORATION BETWEEN SECTORS : THE ROLE OF COORDINATION

- Stakeholders involved in festivals share a common objective: **ensuring public health and safety** in relation to drug-related challenges. However, **progress towards this objective remains fragmented**, with each actor often operating according to their own initiatives and perspectives.
- **A coordinating function is crucial** to establish an integrated approach encompassing prevention, harm reduction, care and enforcement. Yet, this function is often perceived as an “added value” rather than as a fundamental necessity.
- It is therefore essential to establish such a coordinating function, which should not depend on the internal organisation of individual festivals. It **should be supported by public authorities or a neutral body**, in order to ensure coherence across festivals and alignment with the national drug policy.

APPENDIX 3.

SUMMARY OF FINDINGS FROM PHASE 1

DRUG USE AT MUSIC FESTIVALS

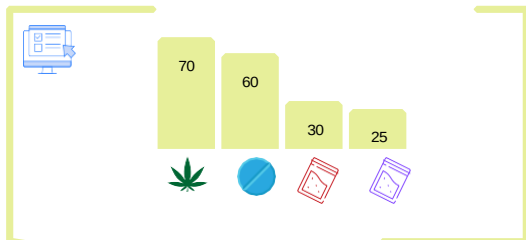
Audience profile



1

- **27% of survey respondents used** illegal drugs during the festival.
- **All age groups** are concerned.

Illicit substances used



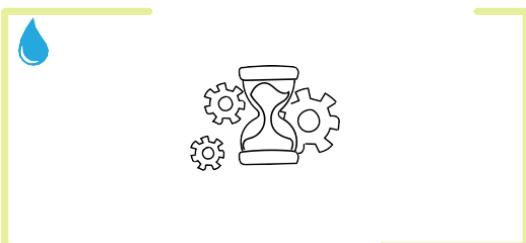
2

- The four most commonly used illegal substances are **cannabis**, **ecstasy/MDMA**, **cocaine** followed by the **ketamine**.
- Harm reduction services observe **more ecstasy/MDMA than cannabis** in their follow-ups in the **relax zone**.



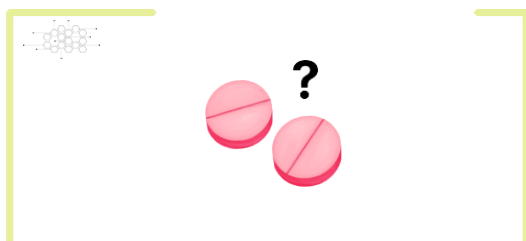
3

- Qualitative observations confirm the use of several drugs, including **nitrous oxide**, which is less visible in the other data sources.



4

- The analysis of the wastewater is underway. Data from previous years **confirm the presence of almost all substances** known to circulate on the drug market in Belgium.



5

- Analysis of drugs seized by the police indicates that **the composition reported by users does not always correspond** to the actual composition. This confirms findings from other research conducted at Sciensano.



PUBLIC ATTITUDES TOWARDS SUPPORT SERVICES

Adverse effects

- 1 • Almost **10% of survey respondents** who had used illicit drugs and/or alcohol reported **adverse effects**.
- 2 • **Respondents 30 and younger** seem to be particularly concerned.
- 3 • According to our interviews, **foreign festival-goers** are more affected by adverse effects, highlighting the importance of prevention and intervention actions during the event.

Preferred sources of support

- 4  • Among the services available, first aid is the most in demand, but **drugs are rarely discussed**.

Information search

- 5 • **20% of survey respondents felt the need to learn about** a substance, most of them searched for information online.
- 6 • When survey respondents did not turn to available help, it was often due to a **lack of trust**.
- 7 • **90% of festival-goers** who have used drugs express **the need to know the concentration** of the substance consumed.

Data on health incidents

- 8 • First aid does not systematically collect data on drug use and it is not **always possible to link drug use to health incidents**.
- 9 • Based on our interviews, major incidents often concern **polysubstance use**, but these type of incidents are frequently underreported.



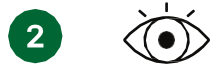
HARM REDUCTION: BEFORE, DURING AND AFTER FESTIVALS

Observed harm reduction initiatives



- 1 • The survey and qualitative observations reveal the presence of a **variety of initiatives** : amnesty boxes, alcohol tests, relax zones, alert buttons, free drinking water, information stands, etc.

Effectiveness



- According to qualitative observations, a greater number of festival-goers were observed lying in open spaces and **appearing distressed, in the absence of relax zones**.



- According to EUDA, "***The implementation** of environmental prevention measures to reduce substance-related harm and **harm reduction interventions**, supported by guidelines and standards, **is important***" (2022).

- These still require **more in-depth evaluations**.

Challenges



- **Variable visibility** : HR measures are unevenly noticed by survey respondents.
- **Turnover** : The high turnover of HR staff represents a significant challenge to ensure the stability of service delivery (based on qualitative interviews and scientific literature).
- **Budget** : The implementation of the measures still relies heavily on the festivals alone and is highly dependent on their respective budgets.

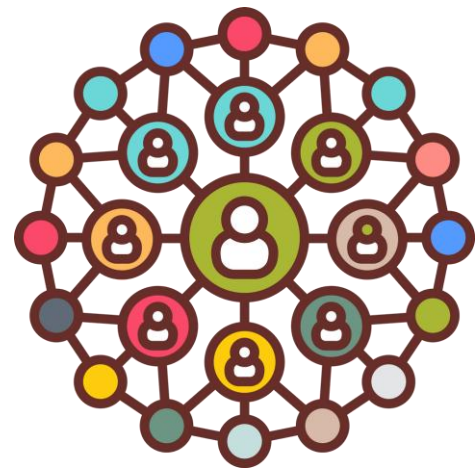
TRAINING AND COLLABORATION BETWEEN SECTORS: THE ROLE OF COORDINATION

1 Training



There are several case scenarios in terms of training of health and safety staff regarding drug-related issues:

- **Training of all staff** before the festival on harm reduction principles and harassment.
- **No HR or first aid training** at the level of *care teams* due to turnover and limited budget. First aid staff more or less informed about the specificities of drugs.
- ...



2 Collaboration



The same applies to the level and type of collaboration:

- Some first aid services **regularly interact** with the relax zones, and sometimes with the bar staff (WhatsApp groups, regular visits, etc.).
- In other places, they **do not know each other** and work independently.
- ...

3 Coordination



Overall, better coordination between sectors **fosters public trust and satisfaction**, according to our interviews.

APPENDIX 4.

KEY PRIORITY ACTIONS BASED ON FINDINGS FROM PHASES 1 & 2

1. A more integrated risk reduction strategy

A harm reduction strategy must be further integrated into national drug policy, and supported by clear and concrete guidelines. The visibility and recognition of this strategy must be strengthened throughout the year and extend beyond individual festivals.

2. Strategy for Research and Monitoring of Drugs and incidents

Stakeholders in the party scene face common challenges. A pre-established research agenda is therefore essential to support the development of effective drug-related measures, especially at festivals. Coordinated efforts, based on harmonised guidelines and regular exchanges of information, are crucial to improve festival preparation.

3. Impact assessments of drug-related measures

Drug-related measures require thorough impact assessments to avoid reliance on the opinions of professionals at the local level. This includes initiatives such as drug testing, communication by organizers around drugs, as well as police and security measures, which must be based on evidence-based practices. Involving experts from lived experience in evaluation processes is also crucial to improve the relevance of these measures.

4. Clarification of the legislative framework

The legislative framework on drugs and associated measures needs to be clarified. The events sector would benefit greatly from the adoption of a standardised model by the king's prosecutors at the local level. This would promote a coherent approach and harmonised public services from one festival to another in Belgium.

5. A coordinated framework with clear guidelines

A coordinated framework must be put in place to ensure continued support for drug-related measures at events, whether they are large festivals or smaller ones. Clear supporting guidelines should be provided to help organisers implement these measures, regardless of the size or funding capacity of their event.

6. A coordination function to foster an integrated approach

When organising a festive event, a coordination function is essential to put in place an integrated approach that includes prevention, harm reduction, care and law enforcement measures. This function should be supported by public authorities or a

neutral entity to ensure consistency between festivals and to align with national drug policy.

7. The implementation of up-to-date training

Trainings are essential to ensure that all staff are informed and prepared to act in accordance with national drug policy, while improving access to support services. Law enforcement, security guards, healthcare staff and event staff must have a good understanding of this policy, be aware of the specific measures of each event and be able to respond appropriately to drug-related situations. This can be supported by monitoring bodies and prevention institutes, which play a key role in support and training.